process proc · ess

Definition

noun

1. actions taken to make or do something.

   We are learning the process of baking bread.

2. changes or acts that happen one after another.

   The process of growing up takes many years.

verb

1. to handle, treat, or change something by following certain steps.

   That factory processes aluminum into foil.
   She processes all the invoices for the company.

Advanced Definition

noun

1. a systematic sequence of actions used to produce something or achieve an end.

   Her process of writing a novel begins with getting an idea and sketching it out.
   An assembly-line process made the mass production of automobiles possible.

2. a continuous series of changes, functions, or operations.

   The process of becoming a responsible adult can take many years.

3. movement onward or forward; progression.
4. a summons ordering a person to appear in court.
5. the entire course of a legal proceeding.

transitive verb

1. to handle, treat, or transform according to a systematic procedure.

   The new computers processed data at very high speeds.

2. to treat or manufacture according to a particular procedure.

   We saw how they process cheese.

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3. to serve with a court summons.

adjective

1. treated or modified by artificial means, as food.

Spanish cognate

proceso: The Spanish word *proceso* means process.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. An athlete should never return to a sport before a concussion has fully healed, says Mihalik. The process takes at least a week, often longer.
2. Rivers and streams carried sediment from the mountains eastward, where it slowly built up to form the High Plains in the western-central United States. In the process, water was trapped underground.
3. One box of fries fills about 50 percent of your daily allowance of fat. The cooking process also produces the chemical acrylamide, which in high doses has been linked to cancer and nerve damage.
4. Nuclear energy is created by the splitting of the nucleus of an atom. That process is called nuclear fission.
5. Some vendors sell only “organic” foods. Organic produce usually isn’t more nutritious than other fruits and vegetables. To receive official certification, farms follow specific guidelines, such as not using certain pesticides or fertilizers. (Some farms don’t go through the certification process but still may produce food according to organic practices.)
6. Huge studies of 300 to 3,000 people put the study item up against the usual therapy. In most cases, neither patients nor researchers know who’s getting the experimental treatment (a process called blind testing), and some patients (the control group) get just the standard treatment instead.
7. Mannar is president of the Micronutrient Initiative (MI), a nonprofit organization based in Canada. He’s also a chemical engineer and an expert in fortification, the process of adding nutrients to food.
8. Nuclear reactors, such as those at the Fukushima Daiichi plant in Japan that was damaged by the 2011 earthquake and tsunami, split uranium atoms. That action releases energy. The energy is used to boil water, which in turn creates steam that moves turbines that make electricity. When everything works, the process doesn’t pollute the air thing or water.
9. For nearly 20 years, Ikram has been studying the dead of ancient Egypt, becoming an expert in animal mummification. She has tried to determine the ingredients ancient Egyptians used to preserve the animals. One of the main ingredients in the process was natron, a native Egyptian salt often found at the edges of lakes.
10. Don’t be afraid to ask questions about the process or what you’ll be left with afterward. Be sure to spend time thinking about the way you want it all to look—and how it might look to you, or to others, years down the road. When it comes to tattoos, for instance, Savanna says it’s best to choose designs that are truly meaningful.

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